



“Our company views ESG as a valuable tool for enhancing profitability by identifying areas where we can improve efficiency, mitigate risks, and capitalise on emerging opportunities”

VIKASH KUMAR

MANAGER, SUSTAINABILITY, NTPC

INDIA INC. SHOWS THE WAY



NTPC

Has taken steps to reduce carbon footprint; invested in renewable energy projects; implemented robust corporate ESG governance frameworks



BRITANNIA INDUSTRIES

Boosted renewable electricity usage; has switched to cleaner fuels in factories; using energy-efficient equipment to reduce carbon footprint



INDUS TOWERS

Evaluates top partners on ESG parameters; assigns ESG maturity scores to partners; conducts trainings to build capabilities and improve ESG awareness

social data. The system is equipped with strong internal controls to support the underlying integrity and credibility of BRSR disclosures. The data related to environment and social performance, unless otherwise specified in the respective sections, is based on the actual performance of various businesses of the company (including units, hotels and office complexes), subsidiaries, associate firms and third-party manufacturers included in the reporting boundary.

THE WAY AHEAD

Given the challenges companies are facing, Rama Patel, Senior Director and Chief Ratings Officer at CRISIL ESG Ratings & Analytics Ltd, says reporting on non-financial disclosures continues to evolve and regulators worldwide are pushing for standardised, reliable, and transparent disclosures. She adds that to improve the quality of disclosures, companies should invest in strong data collection processes to ensure completeness and consistency of data. As this is an evolving space, investments in skill-building and training of employees on ESG could go a long way in improving disclosures. Even investing in technology and AI- & ML-driven data analytics to enhance ESG data collection, monitoring, analysis and reporting capabilities is crucial.

Sustainability and ESG considerations are increasingly becoming important factors for not just investors but also customers worldwide, with some even willing to pay a premium for ‘sustainable products’. A study conducted by Bain & Company in 2022 revealed that more than half (52%) of urban Indian consumers anticipate increasing their expenditure on sustainable brands over the next three years. Increasingly, consumers are considering the environmental and social impact of the products they buy. They prefer brands that prioritise sustainability, use eco-friendly materials, minimise waste, and demonstrate a commitment to ethical labour practices and community engagement. As Singh of Deloitte warns, companies that do not prioritise ESG will lose business opportunities to their peers going forward.

In the pages that follow, find out India Inc.’s progress on the path to sustainability and the challenges ahead. **BT**

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